

didn't put in the best performances on those days. But then we went away and got good wins in Kolkata and Chennai.

That's just the nature of T20 cricket and the IPL, where anyone can beat anyone. There are a lot of positive signs to move forward when the team comes back to play at the home stadium next year.

Punjab Kings has one of the most formidable fast bowling line-ups, comprising Chris Woakes, Kagiso Rabada, Arshdeep Singh, Harshal Patel, and you. With the game going the batters' way, what were the conversations that the bowling group had while preparing for the games?

We have been quite lucky this year, as we have had a nice contingent of fast bowlers and even some of the guys that haven't played—you look at Woakes, who has such experience. It's been really good to be able to chat with each other and, when we are training, learn from each other.

That's the great thing about the IPL—you can pick each other's brains. I have chatted quite a bit with Arshdeep about left-arm bowling and the little things we can work on

together. Harshal's coming in as an experienced player for our team has been fantastic. He has been in a really good rhythm over the last few games. KG (Rabada) is one of the world's best bowlers in all formats. So, he has been great to be around. A lovely guy who's keen to share ideas and is very positive.

The T20 World Cup is around the corner. The wickets in the US are untested, whereas the ones in the West Indies could be slightly slower. As a fast bowler, how do you plan to adapt to the conditions?

We don't play in the US since our group (Group B) is in the Caribbean. The wickets are different at each venue. There are some very high winds there as well, which could be a factor when you're bowling.

Some surfaces might turn a little bit, so you can use your slower balls and use the pitch, whereas some grounds will be a bit smaller with high winds. We just adjust to the conditions on the day. We've got a very experienced bowling attack, and we will have our plans. There are so many good teams; it'll be tough to pick the winner right away.

Being the defending champion, surely there will be a lot of expectations from England...

Going into another World Cup year is hugely exciting. We are defending champions, and we take a lot of confidence from that. We have a few games against Pakistan to prepare for the World Cup, and it will be really good for the team to come together after a long time apart.

We are going to play in the Caribbean, which is a fantastic place to play cricket. But it's a World Cup, where you have to take one game at a time. That's what we did well in Australia last time when we won it. I am sure the messaging will be very similar. Everyone starts with zero points.

Whoever adjusts best to the conditions will have an advantage. We will be ready for our first game when it comes in early June. Expectations are always going to be there for a team like England — from all big teams, for that matter. India is a very strong team, as are South Africa and Australia. The West Indies, the home nation, are a fantastic team as well. Come the end of June, and we will be up at the final, fingers crossed.



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« Come the end of June, and we will be in the T20 World Cup final, fingers crossed »